

Chapter 12-2

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Liang Shi wasn't familiar with the restaurants around here and didn't know which ones were good.

Fortunately, Xu Qingzhu didn't ask her to choose. As soon as they got in the car, she handed over her phone with the destination already set, telling her to just follow the GPS.

After arriving at the restaurant, Liang Shi went to park the car first, letting the Xu sisters go in ahead.

The parking lot was quiet. She sat in the driver's seat for a while, waiting until her spirits had recovered somewhat before going in.

This was a very elegant Western restaurant. Xu Qingzhu had already ordered for her in advance. After she went in, she politely said thank you.

Xu Qingya looked up at her, "Sister Liang Shi, you now..."

Liang Shi: "Hmm?"

Xu Qingya clicked her tongue, "Have a bit of a wife-slave¹ quality to you."

"Do I?" Liang Shi awkwardly touched her nose tip. She was just being polite by saying thank you.

How did this get connected to being a wife-slave?

"Yes, yes, you do." Xu Qingya nodded frantically, "Everyone who knows you, who doesn't know that the Liang family's second miss is someone who shows no respect to elders and is arrogant and unruly?"

Liang Shi: "..."

Ah, this.

"Alright." Just then their food arrived, and Xu Qingzhu interrupted at the right moment, "Okay, let's eat."

Xu Qingya shrugged indifferently, "Maybe it was just rumors. I think Sister Liang Shi has always been pretty good."

Xu Qingzhu glanced at her, "How much benefit did she actually give you?"

"None. Don't you think Sister Liang Shi is good?" Xu Qingya asked.

Xu Qingzhu: "..."

She said coldly and clearly, "Eat."

"If you think she's not good, why would you still marry her?" Xu Qingya made a cutting sound, then looked at Liang Shi with fangirl eyes, "Sister Liang Shi is so gentle with you."

Liang Shi herself felt unworthy listening to this.

Probably no one in the Xu family knew what kind of situation Xu Qingzhu had been in before.

After all, the original body was good at pretending in front of the Xu family.

Back then, to get Father Xu to marry Xu Qingzhu to her, she had even knelt in the Xu family's living room for an entire day.

The most terrifying thing was when everyone thought she treated you very well.

Only you yourself knew what kind of living hell you were going through.

Liang Shi looked at Xu Qingzhu, and her heart suddenly ached.

For a moment, she empathized completely.

Just like how everyone thought that being without father or mother meant she didn't have to be controlled, standing in the spotlight, bright and dazzling.

But no one knew how lonely she was when she returned alone to her empty home, not daring to fall in love, with no one to confide in.

Xu Qingzhu noticed her gaze and looked back, the corners of her lips curving, "What are you looking at me for? Eat."

Liang Shi forked over the foie gras from her plate, "You eat first, eat more."

"Such public displays of affection," Xu Qingya teased.

At this moment, Liang Shi's phone rang. She glanced at the screen - it was Cheng Ran.

She frowned and hung up.

Xu Qingya asked, "Why didn't you answer?"

Liang Shi blocked that number, "It's someone I don't really like."

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Meanwhile, on the other side of the city, at Cris Bar.

A beautiful-looking Alpha sat at the bar, drinking glass after glass of alcohol, dialing her phone with her fingers.

But the mechanical electronic voice came through the receiver: "Sorry, the number you have dialed is turned off."

The wine glass in her hand instantly flew out, shattering into transparent fragments.

Cheng Ran pressed her temples and couldn't help but swear, "Fuck."

"Liang Shi has really fucking lost her mind." Cheng Ran gulped down another mouthful of alcohol, "Just because of one Xu Qingzhu, she wants to cut ties with me? Besides, I fucking didn't even touch Xu Qingzhu. Who was the one bullying Xu Qingzhu all this time? Fuck. Trash, how did she suddenly start being such a bootlicker²?"

She cursed for a while, then let out a breath, "No, I need to know what the hell happened to this piece of shit."

"Could it be that Xu Qingzhu threatened her?" Cheng Ran said as she dialed a number, and the other side quickly picked up.

Cheng Ran pressed her temples and ordered with drunken authority, "Help me investigate someone."

"Who?"

Cheng Ran said, "Liang Shi."

After saying this, she added, "Also, Xu Qingzhu, and the Xu family's current financial situation."

A few seconds later, she added, "Most importantly, what exactly happened to Liang Shi at the hospital yesterday and today. I want to know every detail."

She didn't believe Liang Shi could change overnight.

Footnotes:

¹ **Wife-slave (老婆奴)**: Chinese slang term describing a man (or in this case, person) who is completely devoted to and controlled by their wife/romantic partner, often in a somewhat exaggerated or doting way. It implies being extremely accommodating and subservient to one's partner.

² **Bootlicker (舔狗)**: Internet slang referring to someone who desperately tries to please someone else (usually in romantic contexts) by being overly accommodating or submissive, often without getting anything in return. Similar to "simp" in English internet culture.